

San Fairy Ann Cycling Club Newsletter

December 2025

Creator Lorna Stafford

2025 – A Year on the Road Together

Thank You for Being Part of the Ride

As another year draws to a close, we'd like to take a moment to look back on the rides, the friendships, and the memories that made 2025 such a special year for San Fairy Ann Cycling Club.



Christmas Party – A Festive Success



1 - Shikha and Jo, giving Santa a cuddle.



2 - For glorious food



3 - Raffle prize, Christmas Hamper worth £75.



4 - John Gibbons band

A Sparkling Christmas Sell-Out!

Our Christmas party at The Unicorn in Marden was packed to the rafters and buzzing with festive cheer. Huge thanks to **Stephen Harmer** for pulling it all together and to the **John Gibbons Band** for keeping the party atmosphere alive. And of course, the highlight of the night — a **surprise visit from Santa himself**, spreading joy (and a few cheeky gifts) around the room.

Santa Rides – Festive Fun on Two Wheels





There were great turnouts' for the group Santa rides, and some of you made a real effort to get into the Christmas spirit on a frigid and foggy morning!

2025 Firsts & Highlights

A Landmark Year for the SFA Ladies!

This year saw the exciting launch of the **SFA Ladies Group**, the first in the Club's history. Created to bring like-minded women together, the group has been all about supporting each other in health, nutrition, fitness, and smashing those cycling goals.

And what a debut year it's been. We kicked things off in style with our very first **ladies' bike-packing weekend**, brilliantly led by Marjory. It was superbly organised, full of laughs, and an absolute treat for those lucky enough to join. Even the weather decided to behave, giving us the perfect backdrop for an unforgettable adventure. If you would like to join, drop Lorna a WA.



5 - The first of 15 Ladies events this year!

First Club Gravel Ride



6 - I think I need a shower!



7 - Let's do it!



8 - You're right, it definitely needs a cleaning!



9 - Opps, I broke it!

Gravel & CX Group — First Ride, organised by Jeremy.

“Loved that ride today, all that mud, the huge puddles, and those slippery tyres definitely made things a *weeee* bit tricky!”

The group’s debut outing had everything you’d hope for from a proper Gravel & CX adventure: messy, challenging, hilarious, and absolutely brilliant fun. It set the tone perfectly for what this new group is all about: exploring off-road, embracing the elements, and enjoying the ride together.

We’re looking to grow the group as we head into the new year, so if you fancy getting stuck into some muddy miles with a friendly bunch, come along and give it a go. The more the merrier!

E Group Relaunch — EasyRiders Are Back!



We're delighted to share that the E Group, led by Mike Lambourne, is officially up and running again. With two successful rides already completed and another planned for 3rd January, the group is off to a brilliant start. The E (for EasyRider) Group has been reformed to offer a welcoming space for those new to cycling, returning after injury, or simply looking for a gentler pace. And if you know someone who may have enjoyed Christmas just a little too enthusiastically, this could be the perfect way for them to ease back into the saddle. If you or someone you know would like to join in, Mike is always happy to chat. You can reach him on **07949 184250**.

We are delighted to announce Our New Kit Officer!



When Linton Schwarz graciously (read: *lightly press-ganged*) stepped in to help with the ordering and rollout of our new Club kit, none of us expected how brilliantly he would take

to the role. He did such an outstanding job that we've officially asked him to become the Club's **Kit Officer**, and thankfully, he's agreed!

As we continue to roll out our new kit and maintain the Club's high standard of presentation, Linton's role will be absolutely key. We're delighted to have him on board and deeply grateful for the energy and care he's already brought to the job.

A Fresh Start: Introducing the New SFA Club App! 📱



As the club has grown, so has the amount of information we share — and with more of us checking ride details on our phones, it became clear that having a more mobile-friendly option would make life much easier. With that in mind, **Mark Phillipson** has created something designed exactly for how we plan and enjoy our rides today: the brand-new **SFA Club App. Fairies Little Helper**

The app brings all the essentials together in one simple, easy-to-use place:

- **Ride Group Calendars** – Quickly check upcoming rides for each group
- **Club Links** – Direct access to club resources and WhatsApp
- **Weather** – Local Kent weather at a glance
- **Groups/Settings** – Choose which ride groups you want to follow
- **Café List** – A handy guide to recommended cycling cafés
- **Specification** – Full details on how the app works
- **Feedback** – A GitHub link for suggestions or improvements

It's a fantastic step forward for the club, and we're incredibly grateful to Mark for the time, care, and expertise he's put into creating it. [For more details and to download click here:](#)

Cup Captain – Keeper of the Glory!

SAN FARIY ANN CC's Trophy & Medals Maestro 2026



Do you love a bit of sparkle, ceremony, and the thrill of seeing champions celebrated? Then step up as our **Cup Captain**, the person who makes sure our trophies and medals shine as brightly as our winners.

This isn't about paperwork or drudgery. It's about being the heartbeat of our celebrations, the one who ensures every medal is polished, every name engraved, and every winner gets their moment in the spotlight.

🌟 What you'll do (with flair!)

- **Guard the silverware:** Keep track of racing and non-racing trophies, make sure they're engraved and ready.
- **Medal magic:** Coordinate with Afords in Bearsted so our 1st, 2nd & 3rd place medals arrive on time.
- **Presentation perfection:** Help line up the trophies for the Birthday Lunch, so the president can hand them out in style.
- **Shine & sparkle:** Give the trophies a clean so they gleam on the big day.
- **Celebrate champions:** Ensure winners who can't attend still get their awards later.

🎉 Why it matters

Without a Cup Captain, the silverware stays in lofts, medals don't get engraved, and our Birthday Lunch loses its magic. With you, every winner feels celebrated, every trophy tells a story, and the club's traditions live on.

🕒 Time needed

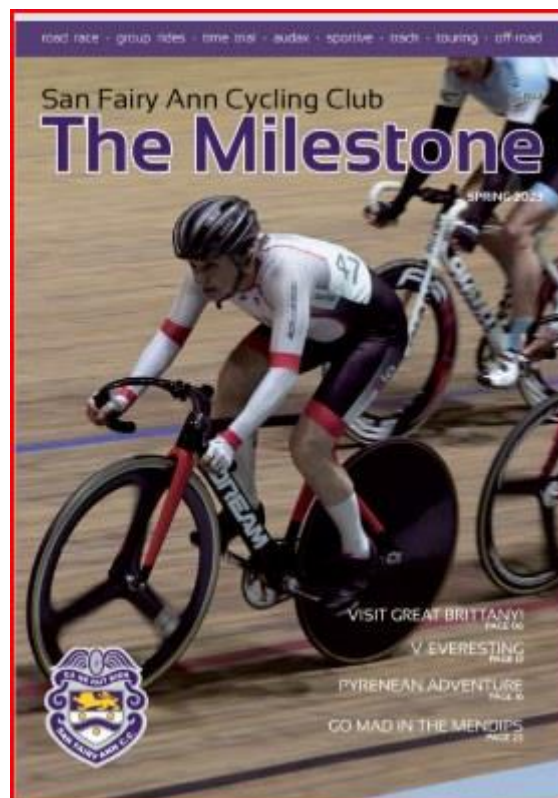
A sprinkle of organisation here, a dash of coordination there – most of the work happens around the Birthday Lunch. It's not about hours of grind, it's about moments of glory.

🏆 Formal & Prestigious

Cup Captain, Keeper of the Club's Honour

Step into a role of tradition and pride. Ensure our trophies gleam, our medals are ready, and our champions are celebrated with dignity. **A vital role, light in time but rich in meaning. If you could help the club for a few hours, please contact John Longbottom on 07970 886565.**

🏠 **372 Readers. 0 Submissions. We Need to Talk...** 🏠



10 - (Or it may go the way of The Milestone...)

Last month, more than **372 of you** opened this newsletter — brilliant!

But not a single story was sent this month **Zero!**

Keep that up, and next month's issue will just be a photo of me washing my bike, and no one needs to see that.

We know you're out there riding great routes, finding mystery lanes, and discovering cafés with dangerously good cake. These are the stories we want to share. You don't need to be a writer, just tell us who, what, where, when, and add a photo if you've got one. We'll do the rest.

Remember **The Milestone**? It didn't vanish because people stopped loving it, it vanished because contributions stopped. Let's not let this newsletter go the same way.

If you enjoy reading this and want it to continue, we need your voice.

If you rode it, fixed it, found it, climbed it, crashed it, ate it, or had a brilliant holiday, **send it in**. You might inspire someone else.

✉ membership@sanfairynn.co.uk

Don't wait for someone else.

This is your club — let's make it your newsletter.

SFACC 2026 EARLY BIRD ENTRY ON SALE NOW!

The SFA Sportive - Sunday 24th May 2026



Early Bird entry CLOSES 31ST JANUARY! So grab a bargain while you can! Head over to [Sportive.com](https://www.sportive.com), search **SFACC Sportive**, and secure your place.

Get ready for a brilliant day out on the bike. **The countdown starts NOW!** 🚴

Save the Dates for 2026

SFA Birthday Party - 21st March - Marden

Special Event with Guest Speaker - 25th March - Weald of Kent Golf Club

13th May - Midweek Time Trails start - Paddock Wood

28th June - Summer Audax - Bethersden Village Hall

6th September - Autumn Audax - Chart Sutton Village Hall

Do you fancy it then?

The Board isn't a closed shop.

It's simply waiting for people like you to step forward.

If you want fresh faces, new ideas, and shared responsibilities, then **be part of the change**.
Next June, put your name forward and help shape the future of the club you care about.

No experience needed. Just enthusiasm, commitment, and a willingness to help.

 **Interested? Curious? Want to know more?**

Email chairman@sanfairyann.co.uk or speak to any current Board member.

Don't wait for someone else to do it.

Next year, that name on the ballot could be yours.

And Finally.



*Thank you to everyone who rode, helped, organised, supported,
and laughed with us in 2025. We can't wait to see where the road
takes us next.*

Club Contacts

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